

“Red-Flag” Consistency Topics — Interview Practice Questions

Practice to be truthful, calm, and consistent. Do not guess or invent details.

Important note (read first)

- These topics are sensitive because inconsistencies can create serious problems.
- Practice ONLY to answer truthfully, clearly, and consistently. Never guess, invent, or hide facts.
- If you are unsure about a date/detail, say “I don’t remember exactly” and check documents later.
- If you have an attorney, review these topics with them before the interview.

1) Prior relationships (dating, marriage, long-term partners)

- Has either of you been married before? If yes: spouse name, marriage date, divorce date, and where the divorce was finalized (city/state/country).
- Have either of you had long-term relationships before this one? (Keep it factual and simple.)
- Do you have any legal documents from prior relationships (divorce decree, custody order)? Where are they stored?
- Did you live with a prior partner? When and where (city/state) and why did it end?
- Are there shared children with a prior partner? If yes, what is the co-parent’s role today (general)?

2) Children and custody schedules (if applicable)

- Do either of you have children? Names/ages (only if required/relevant and you’re comfortable).
- Is there a custody order or written agreement? What is the current schedule (days/times)?
- Who does pickups/drop-offs and where do exchanges happen?
- How are holidays and school vacations handled?
- Who is listed on school/daycare forms as contacts and authorized pick-up?
- Any changes to custody schedule in the last year—what changed and why (factual)?

3) Gaps in living together (timing and reasons)

- Have there been any periods when you were not living together after you started dating/married?

- If yes: exact months/years of the gap (or best estimate) and where each person lived (city + address if known).
- Why did you live apart (lease timing, work location, family obligations, school, housing availability)?
- During that time, how often did you see each other in person (weekly, weekends, etc.)?
- What proof exists from that period (texts, travel receipts, photos, money transfers, visits)?
- Did either of you move residences during that time? List move-in/move-out dates (approx).

4) Past immigration filings and history (only what you truly know)

- Have you filed any prior immigration applications or petitions (any type)? If yes: what type and when (approx).
- Have you ever had a visa, status change, extension, or prior interview? When and for what purpose (general)?
- Have you received any Requests for Evidence (RFE) or notices? When and what did they ask for (general)?
- Have you ever used different addresses on forms? Make sure your address timeline matches your records.
- Do you have copies of prior filings/notices? Where are they stored (attorney portal, email, folder)?
- If you don't know the exact type/date, say so and note that your attorney/records have it.

5) Name changes (legal names, spelling, aliases)

- Has either of you ever changed your name legally? If yes: what was the old name, new name, and date of change.
- Any changes due to marriage/divorce? When and how did you update IDs?
- Has your name ever been spelled differently on documents? Which documents and what is the correct spelling?
- Have you used a nickname professionally or socially? (Clarify it's not a legal name.)
- Where are name change documents kept (court order, marriage certificate, updated ID)?

6) Arrests, citations, tickets, court issues (if any)

- Has either of you ever been arrested, charged, cited, or had a court case (including older incidents)?
- If yes: what happened (brief facts), date (approx), location (city/state), and outcome (dismissed, paid fine, probation, etc.).
- Have you had driving-related issues (DUI/OUI, reckless, suspended license) or any warrants? (Answer truthfully.)
- Do you have official disposition/court records? Where are they kept and can you obtain copies if needed?

- Have you ever been stopped/questioned by immigration or law enforcement? When and outcome (general)?

7) Consistency drills (practice together)

- Both partners should independently answer the same timeline questions, then compare for consistency:
- • When did you start dating? • When did you move in together? • Any gaps living together? • Major trips together?
- Practice answering sensitive questions calmly, in 1–3 sentences, without extra unnecessary detail.
- If you don't remember something, both should use the same truthful phrasing (e.g., "I don't remember the exact date").

8) What to bring/verify (if applicable)

- Address timeline notes (month/year + address).
- Divorce/custody documents (if any).
- Copies of prior immigration notices/receipts (if available).
- Name change documents (if any).
- Court dispositions for any arrests/citations (if any).

*Reminder: If any topic is complex or risky, consult your **attorney**. This document is for practice and organization, not legal advice.*